

56-90-77

SPECIES: Purple Finch
(Vernacular Name)Carpodacus purpureus
(Scientific Name)DATE(S): Jan 15 / Jan 27 TIME OF OBSERVATION: 10-10:30 am ~~10~~ 10:45 - 11:00EXACT LOCATION: West side South Platte River about 500' upstream from Kingfisher bridge
Chaffield SRA.NEAREST TOWN: Kessler COUNTY: JeffersonOTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY IDENTIFIED THIS BIRD: Joey Kellner,
Duane Nelson (photographed bird), Dick Schottler. Reported at original spot
on 1/16, 1/18, 1/21, 1/31. Also seen on 1/24 further upstream beyond loop end of paved
cycle path feeding on Wolf berries. Seen 2/1 on east side of River 1/2 mi from bridgeOPTICAL EQUIPMENT: eyes, Bushnell 10 x 50 AudubonWEATHER CONDITIONS: Clear, SunnyBIRD/SUN ORIENTATION: Not criticalDISTANCE FROM BIRD AND HOW MEASURED: 20-50 feetNUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: ♂ PLUMAGE: BEHAVIOR AND DEMEANOR: Feeding ^{alone} on Wolf berries. Flew back and forth
from berry patch and low limbs of Cottonwood. On 1/27 feeding with
mixed flock of Black-capped and Mountain Chickadees, after 15 minutes
flew with Mtn Chickadees across River into Douglas County.HEAD & NECK (forehead, crown, auricular & malar regions, median line, etc.):
Side of head had two distinct white patches - one on eyebrow, other on side
of face - color otherwise brownish gray.EYES & LORES (supercilium, eye-ring, eye-stripe, color, etc.): —LOWER & UPPER MANDIBLES (color & shape): Finch shape.LEGS & FEET: Did not note details.

UPPERPARTS (nape, back, rump, uppertail coverts, etc.):

Color was quite gray; not really brown.

UNDERPARTS (chin, throat, belly, sides, flanks, crissum, etc.):

Underparts indistinctly and lightly streaked.

RETRICES (inner, middle & outer tail feathers; color, pattern, shape, etc.):

Tail brownish gray, notched.

WINGS (color, length, shape, bars, coverts, etc.): Brownish gray.

VOCALIZATION (call/song, method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight):

Did not sing or chirp.

HABITAT: Riparian, woods along river.

ELIMINATION OF SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

Was not a House Finch or Cassin's Finch.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

Saw the one (or more) seen on the 1989 Xmas count about 1 mile to the east along Plum Creek. Have seen a few in eastern Iowa.

BOOKS, ILLUSTRATIONS AND ADVICE CONSULTED THAT INFLUENCED THIS REPORT:

Confirmed identity using National Geographic Society - Field Guide to the Birds of North America.

THIS REPORT WRITTEN FROM NOTES MADE DURING ☒ AFTER ☐ OBSERVATION; ☐ FROM MEMORY

NAME: Warren I. Finch SIGNATURE: Warren I. Finch DATE: 3/5/90

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A

DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAPE BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

Species: Purple Finch Carpodacus purpureus
(Vernacular name) (Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): 27 Jan 1990 Time Bird Seen: ~ 14:00 to ~ 14:05

Locality: ~ 500 yds below Kingfisher Bridge at Chatfield Reservoir
Denver, CO
Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: Nikon 9x30 bino's,

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: _____

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: ♀ Plumage: adult

Light conditions: Good sun; from angle, also from the back.

Distance from bird, and how measured: 25-100 feet, estimated.

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

The bird flew in to a patch of snowberries. It fed quietly on stalks & twigs near the ground for 2-3 minutes; also perching on mullen stalks. It then flew to branches in a small tree, then gradually worked up high into the tall cottonwoods and then flew east over the river. Was alone and silent. Seemed smallish and rather slow-moving.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

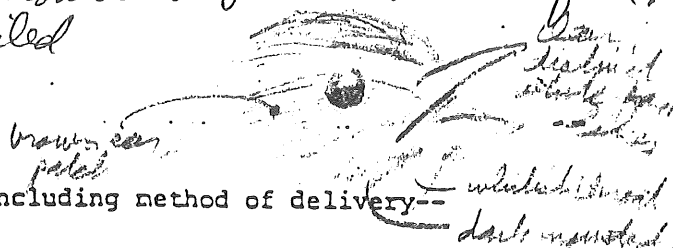
Riparian woodland. Weedy tangle of snowberries

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

Duane Nelson, Warren Finch,

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

Small sparrow-like bird, about 5" long. It looked superficially like a House Finch or Pine Siskin. Above dark brown and streaked. Wings dark with two dull tan wingbars. Underside has a clean white background color with distinct wide brown streaks (actually rows of wide, rounded spots). Throat white. Undertail coverts immaculate white (no streaks). Bill medium-long, small and slightly - brown upper and yellow lower mandible. Face is brown and white - with distinct wide, whitish superciliary and with dark moustache line bordered by white throat and whitish lower face. Overall bird was small with short-tailed with a notch.



Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

Silent

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

Pine Siskin is smaller, has yellow in plumage. Of Carpodacus sp. Finches: Cassin's ♀ has thin streaking below, pointier bill, streaked undertail coverts. House Finch ♀ has longer tail, dull tan & brown streaking below, no face pattern; streaked undertail coverts.

Sparrows (Savannah, Baird's, Song, Fox, Lark Bunting) lack dark face patch set off by white, short notched tail, uniform streaked breast & belly.

Prior experience with this and similar species:

I've seen many House, Cassin's and Purple Finches.

This report was written from notes made during X after observation; from memory .

NAME (print): MARK JANOS

Mailing address: 902 Colorado Ave. La Junta, CO 81050

Signature: Mark Janos

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
c/o Curator - Dept. of Zoological Collections
Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205